

Info

Please get familiar with the Pre-Work to be done - FF / Delivery intake.

Table of Contents | maxLevel = 3

The RAID process, which stands for Risks, Assumptions, Issues, and Dependencies, serves as a crucial framework for managing and mitigating uncertainties and challenges in a fixed-price project. Its purpose is proactively identifying, assessing, and addressing potential risks, assumptions, issues, and dependencies that could impact the project's success.

In summary, the RAID process for a fixed-price project provides a structured approach to navigate uncertainties, make informed decisions, and ensure the project's successful completion within budget, scope, and timeline constraints. It fosters proactive management, effective communication, and continuous improvement, all contributing to the project's success.

RECALL BASICS

Risk	- Risks are potential events or situations that, if they occur, can negatively or positively impact the project's objectives, timelines, budget, quality, or other aspects. - Risks are uncertainties that <u>may or may not happen</u>, but they need to be identified, assessed, and managed proactively to minimize their impact.
Assumption	- Beliefs or conditions that are considered to be true without concrete evidence or proof. - Assumptions can influence decisions and expectations. It's important to recognize and document assumptions so that they can be validated or addressed if they turn out to be incorrect. - Make it a habit to log any assumptions you may concern along the project life.
Issue	- Problems, challenges, or obstacles that have already occurred during the project's execution. - Unlike risks, which are potential future events, issues are current realities that need immediate attention and resolution to prevent negative impacts on the project's progress or outcomes.
Dependency	- Relationships between tasks, activities, or components in a project. - Dependencies exist when one task or activity relies on another for successful completion. - Understanding dependencies is crucial for sequencing tasks correctly and ensuring that the project progresses smoothly without bottlenecks.

In a fixed-price type of project, where the scope, timeline, and budget are predetermined, the purpose of a RAID Log remains consistent with its general definition but takes on added significance due to the constraints of the fixed-price model. The purpose of a **RAID Log** for fixed-price projects includes:

- Risk Mitigation:** Given the fixed budget and timeline, identifying and mitigating risks becomes crucial to avoid **potential cost overruns** or **project delays**. The **RAID Log** helps the project team **identify** and **assess risks** during the **intake stage** that could **impact the project's successful completion** within the agreed-upon parameters.
- Scope Management:** A fixed-price project relies on a **well-defined scope**. The **RAID Log** aids in tracking **potential scope creep** (unauthorized changes to the project scope), ensuring that **any requested changes are documented**, evaluated for **impact**, and **approved**, thus safeguarding the project's financial and temporal boundaries.
- Change Management:** Any changes to the project, whether in scope, requirements, or other aspects, must be meticulously managed in a fixed-price project. The **RAID Log** assists in **capturing change requests**, assessing their **impact on cost** and **schedule**, and obtaining necessary approvals.
- Issue Resolution:** To adhere to the fixed budget and timeline, timely resolution of issues is essential. The **RAID Log** provides a structured **mechanism to log, assign ownership, and monitor the progress of issues** to prevent them from causing costly delays.

5. **Dependency Management:** External dependencies can directly impact the project's ability to meet fixed deadlines. **The RAID Log** helps identify and **track these dependencies**, allowing the team to **manage them effectively** and **avoid disruptions**.
6. **Assumption Validation:** Assumptions made at the project's outset can impact its success. **The RAID Log** enables the team to validate these assumptions and take corrective actions if they prove incorrect, minimizing potential budget or timeline risks.

CHEKLISTS

Checklist for a RAID Log in Fixed Price Projects

1. **Risks:**
 - Identify potential risks impacting the project's fixed price, timeline, or scope.
 - Assess the likelihood and potential impact of each risk.
 - Develop mitigation strategies for high-priority risks.
 - Assign responsibility for risk management and track mitigation progress.
 - Document all the above and count on it during **the Estimation stage**.
2. **Assumptions:**
 - Evaluate and revise all assumptions made during the **project initiation**.
 - Add/Update all assumptions during the **project intake stage**.
 - Regularly review and validate assumptions to ensure their accuracy.
 - Count on all assumptions during the **Estimation stage** and buffer for the further risk meetings.
 - Address and adjust project plans if assumptions change or prove incorrect.
3. **Issues:**
 - Log any project issues or challenges that arise during the intake and execution.
 - Assign ownership for issue resolution and establish clear action plans.
 - Monitor issue resolution progress and update the log as issues are resolved.
4. **Dependencies:**
 - Identify external dependencies that could impact the project's fixed timeline.
 - Communicate and coordinate with external stakeholders to manage dependencies.
 - Update the log with dependency status and any changes.
5. **Scope Changes:**
 - Document any requested changes to the project scope.
 - Evaluate the impact of scope changes on budget and timeline.
 - Obtain necessary approvals before implementing scope changes.
6. **Change Requests:**
 - Record and evaluate change requests, considering their impact on fixed parameters.
 - Seek approval for changes that deviate from the original agreement.
7. **Communication and Reporting:**
 - Regularly update the RAID Log and communicate its contents to stakeholders.
 - Include RAID Log updates in project status reports and meetings.

By following this checklist and maintaining a comprehensive RAID Log, project teams can effectively manage risks, assumptions, issues, and dependencies in fixed-price projects, ensuring successful project delivery within agreed-upon constraints.

Checklist for a RAID Log when transitioning a project from a T&M model to a Fixed Price Project

1. **Risks:**
 - Identify potential risks associated with transitioning from T&M to Fixed Price.
 - Assess the impact of these risks on project scope, timeline, and budget.
 - Determine mitigation strategies for each identified risk.
 - Assign ownership and accountability for risk mitigation.
2. **Assumptions:**
 - List assumptions made during the transition process.
 - Validate the accuracy and relevance of these assumptions in the new model.
 - Document any changes or adjustments required due to different pricing structures.
 - Ensure all stakeholders understand and agree upon the updated assumptions.
3. **Issues:**

- Review current issues or challenges faced under the T&M model.
- Determine how these issues might be affected by the transition.
- Devise a plan for resolving or minimizing these issues in the Fixed Price model.
- Assign responsibility for issue resolution and track progress.

4. Dependencies:

- Identify project dependencies that the transition might impact.
- Communicate the changes in project model to dependent teams or stakeholders.
- Assess any potential delays or adjustments needed due to changing dependencies.
- Collaborate with dependent teams to ensure a smooth transition.

5. Logistics:

- Determine the specific timeline for transitioning from T&M to Fixed Price.
- Allocate resources and budget for activities related to the transition.
- Establish communication channels and protocols for updating stakeholders about the transition progress.
- Plan and conduct training or information sessions for teams affected by the transition.

6. Communication:

- Develop a concise communication plan to inform stakeholders about the model change.
- Define key messages and talking points for different stakeholder groups.
- Ensure that concerns and questions from stakeholders are addressed promptly and transparently.
- Regularly update stakeholders on the progress of the transition.

7. Financial Analysis:

- Evaluate the financial implications of the transition, including cost savings or potential overruns.
- Compare the projected costs under the Fixed Price model with historical data from the T&M model.
- Assess the accuracy of the Fixed Price estimate and adjust as necessary based on the analysis.
- Prepare a detailed financial report for stakeholders outlining the cost and budget changes.

8. Quality Assurance:

- Define quality metrics and standards applicable to the Fixed Price model.
- Ensure that the transition does not compromise the quality of deliverables.
- Establish a process for monitoring and measuring quality during and after the transition.
- Conduct reviews and audits to validate that quality standards are being met.

9. Legal and Contractual Considerations:

- Review existing contracts and agreements related to the T&M model.
- Identify any necessary contract changes or amendments to accommodate the Fixed Price model.
- Consult legal and procurement teams to ensure compliance with contractual obligations.
- Update contract terms to reflect the new pricing structure and scope.

Remember! Each project and organization may have specific nuances, so adapt this checklist accordingly to meet your project's unique needs and circumstances.

Checklist for a RAID Log when transitioning a Fixed Price project from another vendor to EPAM

(Note: the list could be extended taking into account the project specific, don't take it as the final one)

1. Risks:

- Identify potential risky areas associated with the transition process, taking into account tips below:
 - Communication Management
 - Knowledge Transition
 - Data Management (including Data Security & Privacy)
 - Scope Management
 - Skills and Knowledge
 - Resource Management
 - Contract & Budgeting
 - Legal & Compliance
 - Integrations
 - Quality Control
 - Transition to Support.
- Identify potential risks going through the list of areas pre-defined at the previous step and check tips below mentioned:
 - availability of vendor's representatives (and resources shortage);
 - delays along the whole process;
 - precise ownership of the KT process (ideally, there should be an accountable person, who owns the whole process of KT);

- data & content migration issues, data loss or its inaccuracy;
- compliance, privacy & security, legal challenges related to the project data;
- communication breakdown;
- quality concerns and different quality standards;
- precise ownership of the KT process;
- skills/expertise gap;
- resistance to transition process (low level of motivation, performance, contribution level, etc.);
- lack of documentation;
- integration challenges (especially in needs of integrating code done by the other vendor with 3rd parties);
- licences obtainment and financial coverage;
- team location change;
- and other risks related to the project specific.
- Assess the impact of these risks on project scope, timeline, and budget.
- Determine mitigation strategies for each identified risk.
- Assign ownership and accountability for risk mitigation.
- Integrate them into the Project Plan, specifically into continuous review & update process on the project level.

2. Assumptions:

- Identify main areas and list assumptions made during the transition process, which could relate to them. Please see examples below:
 - Knowledge Transfer (e.g., *The outgoing vendor will provide all necessary knowledge and documentation for a seamless handover to EPAM*).
 - Data Accuracy (e.g., *The data provided by the outgoing vendor is accurate and complete, without proper validation*).
 - System Compatibility (e.g., *EPAM systems, tools, and technologies will seamlessly integrate with the existing project infrastructure*).
 - Timeline (e.g., *The transition process will occur within a specific timeframe without considering potential delays (commitments around the timeline done)*).
 - Skill Transfer (e.g., *The skills and expertise of the outgoing vendor's team will easily transfer to EPAM*).
 - Team Familiarity (e.g., *EPAM is familiar with the project's details, specific, previous experience and lessons learned*).
 - Resource Availability (e.g., *EPAM has sufficient resources available to handle the transition without impacting our other commitments*).
 - Stakeholder Support (e.g., *All required stakeholders, both internal and external, will be supportive and cooperative throughout the transition*).
 - Legal & Compliance (e.g., *All legal and contractual requirements will be smoothly handled during the transition*).
 - Communication (e.g., *Communication between the old and new vendors will be effective and timely without addressing potential challenges*).
 - Business Continuity (e.g., *Transition will not disrupt ongoing business operations or customer experiences*).
 - Scope Understanding (e.g., *EPAM understands the project's scope and requirements accurately, all requirements are shared and confirmed*).
 - Budget (e.g., *Transition will be completed within the allocated budget without considering unforeseen costs*).
 - Transition Plan Execution (e.g., *Transition plan will be executed flawlessly without encountering unexpected obstacles*).
- Ensure all stakeholders understand and agree upon these assumptions.
- Integrate them into the Project Plan, specifically into continuous review & update process on the project level.

3. Issues:

- Review available issues log faced with the outgoing vendor (within RFP package, Client's feedback, lessons learned, current state vs desired state, questionnaire filled in, etc. - check FF / Delivery intake)
- Determine which issues will be applicable for the transitioned project.
- Build a plan for resolving or minimizing these issues in the Fixed Price model.
- Assign owners for issue resolution.
- Integrate them into the Project Plan, specifically into continuous review & update process on the project level.

4. Dependencies:

- Identify main areas of possible dependencies for the project-in-transfer from one Vendor to another, e.g.:
 - Data & Information
 - Personnel
 - Process

- Technology, Tools and Infrastructure
- Communication
- Legal & Compliance
- Knowledge Transfer, Onboarding & Training
- Contract & Budget
- Quality Standards
- Timing.
- Determine the list of dependencies and document in a structured manner.
- Integrate them into the Project plan and continuous management process, making sure they are treated with the right priority, in the right sequence.

5. Logistics & Communication:

- Transition of the project from the other vendor will require a proper planning, coordination, and execution to ensure a smooth and successful transfer.
- Clearly define your accountable person from the Client's side who will own the coordination between the outgoing vendor and EPAM.
- Get all the knowledge about the outgoing vendor's team members and their availability, integrate this information into the plan.
- Build a plan/checklist of the transition process with all important phases, actions, inputs/outputs, stakeholders and owners, deadlines and definition-of-done criteria.
- Act as a Team. Involve all required people from your side to this plan preparation to make it complete.
- Confirm the whole plan, timeline/deadlines and outcomes with the Client's Transition Coordinator.
 - Assure, that the definition-of-done for each item within the plan meets this stakeholder understanding. You need to be on the same page about the successful completion of the transition.
- Defined & confirmed plan to be shared to the outgoing Vendor, with involvement of the Client's representative.
- Record & document all KT sessions, having Client's representatives included in all communications. Define upfront centralized repository/data storage for all the data received.

6. Legal and Contractual Considerations (don't be shy to contact your Account Management Team with any questions related):

- Clearly define the ownership and transfer of intellectual property rights related to the project's code, documentation, designs, and other deliverables. Ensure that both vendors are in agreement regarding the transfer of these rights.
- With the Account management team review clauses that require both the old and new vendors to maintain the confidentiality of sensitive project-related information and prevent the disclosure of any proprietary data. Integrate any important information into the Project Plan.
- Analyse if the project involves personal or sensitive data. Identify protection and privacy considerations. Ensure the compliance with applicable data protection regulations.

Remember! Each project and organization may have specific nuances, so adapt this checklist accordingly to meet your project's unique needs and circumstances. Pay attention to the nature of deliverables-under-transition and expectations for the new vendor (EPAM).

BEST PRACTICES

Know Your RAID-Log-Team.

Projects are run by people. RAID log is not a game for one. Your task is to have a full defined list of all contributors for RAID Log (refer to FF / Delivery intake and Stakeholders Register).

Centralized RAID Log Storage.

Make sure your RAID Log is being maintained within the shared centralized location with the easy access and right permissions (view/edit) for all required stakeholders. Remember, it is a tool of collaboration.

Clear Format & Guidelines of Reporting.

Clearly outline guidelines for definitions, categorization, standards and other parts of your RAID log, review and confirm the format with the team.

Assuring that the template is clear, you are assuring a smooth process of logging.

"IT'S ALIVE!" 😊

RAID log should be dynamically reviewed & updated, gathering all required team members in cooperation around it (and you have their names from the step above).

Don't keep it static.

Make sure to set up the continuous review & updates process to keep it relevant and up-to-date.

Communication Plan.

You need a clear understanding on when/how/to whom RAID log will be shared from the Client's side.

Take care about the confirmed formatting, ways of communication and recipients list.

Lessons Learned.

For items closed, make sure to log Lessons Learned - the experience obtained as well as the resolution is highly important information.

Design & Document Process.

Don't drive any process ad-hoc. Design and document plan, required steps and actions. Checklist is one of the easy, but powerful tools, which could help in keeping the approach well-structured, consistent, transparent and traceable.

TEMPLATES (RAID Log template)

RAID Log Template.xls

RAID Log Template.pptx